

Thursday, 30 July 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 27° 19°	BIRMINGHAM Overcast 24° 16°	MANCHESTER Light drizzle 20° 16°	GLASGOW Drizzle 16° 12°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

More than half of England has now officially been declared in drought by the Environment Agency, following an exceptionally hot and dry period.

The declaration covers vast swathes of the country, impacting rivers, crops, and nature. It means water companies can now introduce restrictions like hosepipe bans.

ENVIRONMENT · UK
- 2

A serial killer has been given whole life orders for the murders of two men, as police investigate four more deaths linked to him.

James Desborough received the sentence after being found guilty of the murders. Police are now reviewing four unexplained deaths at a homeless shelter where he had stayed.

CRIME · UK
- 3

Tragic news from the coast, as a seven-year-old boy has died in hospital after getting into difficulty in the water last week.

Musa Ahmed is the third person to die following the incident. Our thoughts are with his family and all those affected by this terrible accident.

TRAGEDY · UK
- 4

A teenage Norwegian 'hitman' has been found guilty of a murder plot here in the UK.

Johannes Natland travelled to Huddersfield last March with the intention of carrying out a 'hit'. The conviction highlights a concerning international dimension to serious crime.

CRIME · UK
- 5

The Prime Minister is holding cross-party talks as he speeds up a review of social care in England, with Andy Burnham not ruling out tax rises.

Burnham's comments suggest that funding solutions, potentially including tax increases, are on the table. The government is keen to address the long-standing challenges facing social care.

POLITICS · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Big congratulations are in order for pop star Madison Beer and NFL player Justin Herbert, who have announced their engagement!**

The happy couple shared the news on social media, including some lovely photos of the proposal. It's always great to hear some positive news from the celebrity world.

ON AIR – What's the most romantic proposal you've ever heard of, or perhaps experienced yourself?

CELEBRITY · NOW
- 2 Strictly's Amy Dowden has credited her dance partner, Carlos Gu, with convincing her not to quit dancing.**

Amy and Carlos are now set to star in the latest series of Celebrity Hunted. It's wonderful to hear how strong partnerships can help people through tough times and keep them doing what they love.

ON AIR – Who's been your biggest supporter or motivator when you've faced a challenge?

TV · UPCOMING
- 3 Elon Musk is taking his 'crusade' to Europe, backing a new film called 'Citizen Vigilante' featuring Armie Hammer.**

The movie reportedly features an American vigilante tearing across an unnamed European country. It's certainly an interesting move for the tech mogul into the world of film production.

ON AIR – Would you be interested in watching a film backed by Elon Musk, or does his involvement not sway your viewing choices?

FILM · UPCOMING
- 4 Greg James has spilled some exciting details about Taylor Swift's wedding, including multiple cakes and stolen keepsakes!**

The DJ shared the gossip on his morning show after flying to New York City for the big event. It sounds like it was quite the celebration!

ON AIR – What's the most unusual or memorable wedding detail you've ever come across?

CELEBRITY · NOW
- 5 The Esports World Cup is getting underway in Paris after a last-minute move from Saudi Arabia.**

The prestigious gaming event had to relocate in just eight weeks. It's a huge undertaking to move such a large-scale event so quickly, but it's now ready to go.

ON AIR – Are you a fan of Esports, or do you prefer traditional sports? What makes a good competition for you?

GAMING · UPCOMING

On the schedule

- 1 The Welsh Rugby Union has confirmed that either Scarlets or Ospreys will be cut from the professional game.**

Details have been given on how one of the two south west Wales teams will be removed. It's a tough decision that will have a huge impact on Welsh rugby.

ON AIR – If you follow Welsh rugby, which team do you think will face the cut, and how will it impact the sport?

RUGBY · UK
- 2 Scottish former world champions and rivals Josh Kerr and Jake Wightman will race in the Commonwealth Games mile final.**

The pair, who have been competing against each other since they were boys, both revelled in their Wednesday warm-up. It promises to be a fantastic showdown in Glasgow.

ON AIR – Who are you backing in the Commonwealth Games mile final – Kerr or Wightman?

ATHLETICS · UK
- 3 Zak Crawley and Harry Brook put on an explosive display, hitting nine sixes between them to secure a win for Sunrisers Leeds.**

They wrapped up an eight-wicket victory over Manchester Super Giants in The Hundred. It sounds like a thrilling match with plenty of big hitting!

ON AIR – Who are your favourite big hitters in The Hundred this season?

CRICKET · UK
- 4 Jack Grealish will miss Manchester City's pre-season tour of Asia as he continues to recover from a foot injury.**

Despite returning to training, Grealish has been left out of the squad. Fans will be hoping he's back to full fitness for the start of the Premier League season.

ON AIR – How important is a full pre-season for players, especially after an injury?

FOOTBALL · UK
- 5 Torrential rain has caused chaos at the athletics in the Commonwealth Games in Glasgow, but England's Amy Hunt still impressed.**

Despite the soggy conditions, Hunt delivered one of several strong performances. It just goes to show the resilience of these athletes!

ON AIR – What's the worst weather you've ever had to compete or play sport in?

ATHLETICS · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'micro-breaks' throughout their day to boost productivity and mood.**
Instead of waiting for a long lunch, a five-minute walk or a quick puzzle can apparently refresh the mind and keep you feeling sharp. It's all about little pockets of calm in a busy schedule.
- 2 The joy of 'shelf-tidying' is being recognised as a surprisingly therapeutic activity.**
Organising books, DVDs, or even spice jars can provide a sense of control and accomplishment. It's a simple, everyday task that offers a mini mental reset.
- 3 Experts are suggesting that 'having a 'finishing-off' jar' for small tasks can reduce procrastination.**
Pop all those tiny, nagging jobs – like sending that email or putting away laundry – into a jar, then pull one out and complete it. It makes small chores feel less overwhelming.
- 4 A study found that 'listening to instrumental covers' of popular songs can enhance focus and creativity.**
Without the distraction of lyrics, the familiar melodies can apparently create a comforting background while you work or relax. It's like having your favourite tunes, but quieter.
- 5 The delightful art of 'identifying distant bird calls' is gaining popularity as a mindful outdoor hobby.**
Armed with apps or guidebooks, nature enthusiasts are finding joy in recognising feathered friends by their songs. It adds a whole new dimension to a country walk.
- 6 Researchers are noting a rise in the appreciation for 'the perfect temperature of a cuppa'.**
No more scalding hot or lukewarm disappointments! People are fine-tuning their brewing methods to achieve that ideal, sip-able warmth for their tea or coffee. It's a small detail that makes a big difference.
- 7 The charming habit of 'leaving anonymous positive notes' in public places is becoming a heartwarming trend.**
A little handwritten message on a park bench or a library book can brighten someone's day unexpectedly. It's a simple act of kindness spreading joy.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if it's going to rain, even though we know it's not very scientific?

ANSWER: STICKING OUR HAND OUT OF THE WINDOW FOR A QUICK 'FEEL'.

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a nice, freshly made sandwich. What is it?

ANSWER: CAREFULLY ALIGNING ALL THE CRUSTS BEFORE TAKING THE FIRST BITE.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know those 'little everyday sounds' that just instantly transport you back to your childhood?**
Perhaps it's the specific chime of an ice cream van, the clang of a school bell, or the distinct whir of an old washing machine. What's that sound for you that's like a time machine for your ears?

- **We all have those 'unusual personal rituals' we perform before starting something important.**
Maybe it's a particular lucky pen you have to use, or you always tap your shoes three times before a big meeting. What's your unique little routine that you just *have* to do?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that in the 17th century, pineapples were so rare and expensive in England that they were often rented for a day to display at parties, rather than eaten?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first public park in the world was actually a royal hunting ground in France, opened to the general public by King Louis XIV after he lost a bet.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£76 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The humble pencil can draw a line 35 miles long and write approximately 45,000 words.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- The first orange was not orange; it was green.
- The King of Hearts is the only king in a deck of cards without a moustache.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The world's smallest chameleon is the Brookesia micra, which can sit comfortably on a human fingertip.

On this day

Day 211 of the year, 154 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abdon and Sennen; Christian feast day: Blessed Edward Powell, Richard Fetherston and Thomas Abel; Christian feast day: Hatebrand; Christian feast day: María Natividad Venegas de la Torre. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1947 — Arnold Schwarzenegger, Austrian-American bodybuilder, actor, and politician, 38th Governor of California
- 1941 — Paul Anka, Canadian singer-songwriter and actor
- 1946 — Jeffrey Hammond, English bass player
- 1970 — Dean Edwards, American comedian, actor, and singer
- 1980 — Justin Rose, South African-English golfer
- 1948 — Otis Taylor, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1991 — Diana Vickers, English singer-songwriter
- 1982 — James Anderson, English cricketer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1971 — Apollo program: On Apollo 15, David Scott and James Irwin in the Apollo Lunar Module Falcon land on the Moon with the first Lunar Rover.
- 1980 — Vanuatu gains independence.
- 1990 — Ian Gow, Conservative Member of Parliament, is assassinated at his home by the IRA in a car bombing after he assured the group that the British government would never surrender to them.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1978 — The 730: Okinawa Prefecture changes its traffic on the right-hand side of the road to the left-hand side.
- 2025 — A magnitude 8.8 earthquake hits Russia, causing tsunamis over the Pacific Ocean.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — Israel's Knesset passes the Jerusalem Law.
- 2011 — Marriage of Queen Elizabeth II's eldest granddaughter Zara Phillips to former rugby union footballer Mike Tindall.

- 2006 — An Israeli airstrike kills 28 Lebanese civilians, including 16 children.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 212 of the year, 153 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Abanoub; Christian feast day: Blessed Cecília Schelingová; Christian feast day: Blessed Solanus Casey; Christian feast day: Fabius. Star sign Leo, birthstone Ruby.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Susan Flannery, American actress
- 1974 — Leona Naess, American-English singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1946 — Gary Lewis, American pop-rock musician
- 1959 — Kim Newman, English journalist and author
- 1981 — Titus Bramble, English footballer
- 1963 — Fergus Henderson, English chef and author
- 1965 — J. K. Rowling, English author and film producer
- 1970 — Ben Chaplin, English actor

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1941 — The Holocaust: Under instructions from Adolf Hitler, Nazi official Hermann Göring orders SS General Reinhard Heydrich to "submit to me as soon as possible a general plan of the administrative material and financial measures necessary for carrying out the desired Final Solution...
- 1975 — The Troubles: Three members of a popular cabaret band and two gunmen are killed during a botched paramilitary attack in Northern Ireland.
- 1999 — Discovery Program: Lunar Prospector: NASA intentionally crashes the spacecraft into the Moon, thus ending its mission to detect frozen water on the Moon's surface.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1975 — The Troubles: Three members of a popular cabaret band and two gunmen are killed during a botched paramilitary attack in Northern Ireland.
- 1970 — Black Tot Day: The last day of the officially sanctioned rum ration in the Royal Navy.

Coming to cinemas

JULY 2026

FRI 31 Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7 Once Upon a Time in a Cinema

FRI 14 Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie

FRI 21 Mutiny; The Bride!

FRI 28 Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4 Conjuring: Last Rites

FRI 11 Resident Evil reboot

FRI 18 The Black Phone 2

FRI 25 Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16 Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller

FRI 23 Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JULY 2026

23 JUL — 2 AUG Commonwealth Games, Glasgow

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10 Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)

SAT 15 Premier League season begins (2026/27)

22–23 Belgian Grand Prix (F1)